

AllergenWise Restaurant Allergen Risk Reduction & Awareness Program

MASTER COURSE BUILD PACKET

PROGRAM POSITIONING

Core Program Philosophy

AllergenWise is a restaurant allergen risk-reduction and awareness training system designed to help restaurants reduce preventable allergen-related mistakes through education, communication, structured procedures, and operational consistency.

This program is NOT designed to guarantee allergen-free food or eliminate all risk.

The purpose of the training is to:

- Improve allergen awareness
- Reduce cross-contact risk
- Improve communication between staff and guests
- Standardize allergen handling procedures
- Support safer food preparation practices
- Reinforce honest and responsible guest communication

Required Disclaimer Language

"No restaurant can guarantee a completely allergen-free environment. This training is designed to support allergen risk reduction through education, communication, and structured procedures."

This language should appear:

- In the course introduction
 - In the legal/risk section
 - Near certification language
 - On public-facing restaurant participation materials
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MASTER COURSE MAP

SECTION 1 — FOUNDATIONS OF FOOD ALLERGENS

Lesson 1.1 — What Is a Food Allergy?

Lesson Purpose

Introduce food allergies, allergic reactions, and the concept of allergen risk reduction.

Lesson Content

A food allergy is an immune system reaction to a food protein. Unlike food preferences or intolerances, allergic reactions can become serious and life-threatening.

Even a small amount of an allergen can trigger a reaction in sensitive individuals.

Restaurants must take all allergy disclosures seriously.

This training is designed to help restaurants reduce allergen risk through education, communication, and structured procedures.

No restaurant can guarantee a completely allergen-free environment. The goal of this program is to improve awareness, reduce preventable mistakes, and support safer food handling practices.

Key Concepts:

- Food allergies involve the immune system
- Small amounts of allergens can trigger reactions
- Allergic reactions can become severe quickly
- Restaurants should focus on risk reduction, not guarantees
- Honest communication is critical

Quiz — Lesson 1.1 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

What is a food allergy?

- A food preference
- A diet choice
- Correct Answer: An immune system reaction to a food protein

- A mild intolerance

Question 2

Can small amounts of an allergen cause a reaction?

- No
- Only in children
- Correct Answer: Yes, even small amounts can trigger a reaction
- Only if raw

Question 3

What is the purpose of this training program?

- Guarantee allergen-free food
- Eliminate all restaurant risk
- Correct Answer: Reduce allergen risk through awareness and structured procedures
- Replace restaurant management

Question 4

Can a restaurant guarantee a completely allergen-free environment?

- Yes
- Only with trained staff
- Correct Answer: No, restaurants cannot guarantee a completely allergen-free environment
- Only during slow hours

Lesson 1.2 — Understanding the Top 9 Food Allergens

Lesson Purpose

Teach the FDA Top 9 allergens, hidden ingredient awareness, and common restaurant sources.

Lesson Content

The FDA identifies 9 major food allergens responsible for the majority of serious allergic reactions in the United States.

Every restaurant staff member should be familiar with these allergens.

1. Milk (Dairy)

Milk is found in cheese, butter, cream sauces, soups, dressings, and many prepared foods.

Common restaurant examples include:

- Alfredo sauce
- Ranch dressing
- Mashed potatoes
- Cream soups
- Cheese blends

2. Eggs

Eggs are commonly used in baking, sauces, breading, desserts, and pasta.

Common restaurant examples include:

- Mayonnaise
- Aioli
- Pancake batter
- Fried food breading
- Desserts

3. Peanuts

Peanuts are a separate allergen from tree nuts and may appear in oils, sauces, desserts, and Asian dishes.

Common restaurant examples include:

- Peanut oil
- Peanut sauces
- Dessert toppings
- Asian marinades

4. Tree Nuts

Tree nuts include almonds, walnuts, cashews, pecans, pistachios, and more.

Common restaurant examples include:

- Pesto
- Nut garnishes

- Desserts
- Nut oils

5. Soy

Soy is commonly found in sauces, marinades, dressings, and processed foods.

Common restaurant examples include:

- Soy sauce
- Teriyaki sauce
- Marinades
- Dressings

6. Wheat

Wheat is a grain found in bread, pasta, breading, flour, and many sauces.

Common restaurant examples include:

- Bread
- Pasta
- Roux
- Fried food breading
- Soy sauce

7. Fish

Fish includes finned fish such as salmon, tuna, cod, and others.

Common restaurant examples include:

- Fish sauce
- Caesar dressing
- Seafood dishes
- Stocks

8. Shellfish

Shellfish includes shrimp, crab, lobster, clams, scallops, and oysters.

Common restaurant examples include:

- Shrimp dishes
- Oyster sauce
- Seafood stock
- Crab mixtures

9. Sesame

Sesame is increasingly common in restaurant foods.

Common restaurant examples include:

- Tahini
- Sesame oil
- Burger buns
- Dressings
- Asian sauces

Important:

Allergens may not always be visible or obvious.

Staff should never guess whether a dish is safe.

Ingredients must always be verified.

Quiz — Lesson 1.2 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

Which of the following is one of the Top 9 allergens?

- Chicken
- Beef
- Correct Answer: Peanuts
- Rice

Question 2

Which allergen is commonly found in tahini and sesame oil?

- Soy
- Wheat
- Correct Answer: Sesame
- Fish

Question 3

Why should staff verify ingredients instead of guessing?

- To improve food presentation
- To reduce food cost
- Correct Answer: Allergens may be hidden in ingredients or sauces
- To speed up service

Question 4

Which of the following is a common hidden source of wheat?

- Water
- Rice
- Correct Answer: Soy sauce
- Lettuce

Question 5

Are peanuts and tree nuts the same allergen?

- Yes
 - Correct Answer: No, peanuts and tree nuts are separate allergens
 - Only in desserts
 - Only in sauces
-

Lesson 1.3 — Understanding Allergic Reactions and Anaphylaxis

Lesson Purpose

Teach the seriousness of allergic reactions and introduce emergency awareness.

Lesson Content

Allergic reactions can range from mild symptoms to severe, life-threatening emergencies.

A severe allergic reaction is called anaphylaxis.

Anaphylaxis can happen quickly and requires immediate action.

Common symptoms may include:

- Hives or rash
- Swelling of the lips, face, or throat
- Difficulty breathing
- Wheezing
- Vomiting
- Dizziness or fainting
- Tightness in the chest

Restaurants should always take allergic reactions seriously.

If a severe reaction is suspected:

- Alert a manager immediately
- Call 911
- Stay with the guest
- Never assume symptoms will improve on their own

Key Concepts:

- Allergic reactions can escalate quickly
- Immediate action matters
- Staff should never ignore symptoms
- Emergency response awareness is critical

Quiz — Lesson 1.3 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

What is the term for a severe allergic reaction?

- Contamination
- Cross-contact
- Correct Answer: Anaphylaxis
- Intolerance

Question 2

Which of the following may be a symptom of a severe allergic reaction?

- Mild hunger
- Headache
- Correct Answer: Difficulty breathing
- Fatigue

Question 3

What should staff do if a severe allergic reaction is suspected?

- Wait to see if symptoms improve
- Ignore the situation
- Correct Answer: Alert a manager and call 911 immediately
- Continue service

Question 4

Should allergic reactions always be taken seriously?

- No
 - Only if severe
 - Correct Answer: Yes, all allergic reactions should be taken seriously
 - Only during busy shifts
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Lesson 1.1 — What Is a Food Allergy?

Quiz: Lesson 1.1 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 1.2 — Understanding the Top 9 Food Allergens

Quiz: Lesson 1.2 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 1.3 — Understanding Allergic Reactions and Anaphylaxis

Quiz: Lesson 1.3 Checkpoint Quiz

SECTION 2 — CROSS-CONTACT AND SAFE HANDLING PROCEDURES

Lesson 2.1 — Understanding Cross-Contact

Lesson Purpose

Teach what cross-contact is, how it occurs, and why it creates allergen risk.

Lesson Content

Cross-contact occurs when allergen proteins are transferred from one food, surface, utensil, or piece of equipment to another.

Even very small amounts of an allergen can trigger a serious allergic reaction.

Cross-contact is different from bacterial contamination.

Examples of cross-contact include:

- Using the same cutting board for multiple foods without proper cleaning
- Shared fryer oil
- Shared grill surfaces
- Reusing utensils between dishes
- Touching allergen-containing food and then touching another dish

Important:

Cooking does NOT remove allergens.

A dish may appear safe while still containing allergen proteins.

Key Concepts:

- Cross-contact can happen easily in busy kitchens
- Small amounts of allergens can cause reactions
- Shared equipment increases risk
- Awareness and proper procedures reduce risk

Quiz — Lesson 2.1 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

What is cross-contact?

- Food spoilage
- Bacteria growth
- Correct Answer: Transfer of allergen proteins from one food or surface to another
- Overcooking food

Question 2

Can small amounts of an allergen cause a reaction?

- No
- Only if raw
- Correct Answer: Yes, even small amounts may trigger a reaction
- Only during cooking

Question 3

Which of the following is an example of cross-contact?

- Using clean utensils
- Washing hands

- Correct Answer: Using the same cutting board without cleaning it properly
- Using sealed ingredients

Question 4

Does cooking remove allergens from food?

- Yes
 - Sometimes
 - Correct Answer: No, cooking does not remove allergens
 - Only frying works
-

Lesson 2.2 — Cleaning and Kitchen Safety Procedures

Lesson Purpose

Teach proper cleaning procedures and safe kitchen practices to reduce allergen risk.

Lesson Content

Proper cleaning procedures are essential for reducing allergen risk.

Simply wiping a surface is not enough to remove allergen proteins.

Staff should:

- Clean and sanitize prep surfaces thoroughly
- Use clean utensils and tools
- Separate allergen-containing foods when possible
- Maintain organized prep areas

High-risk equipment includes:

- Shared fryers
- Shared grills
- Flat tops
- Shared prep surfaces
- Shared pasta water

Important:

Shared fryer oil can transfer allergen proteins between foods.

For example:

French fries cooked in oil previously used for breaded shrimp may no longer be safe for some guests with shellfish allergies.

Key Concepts:

- Cleaning reduces allergen risk
- Wiping alone is not enough
- Shared equipment increases risk
- Organized prep procedures improve safety

Quiz — Lesson 2.2 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

Why is wiping a surface not enough?

- It changes food taste
- It takes too long
- Correct Answer: Wiping may not remove allergen proteins
- It only affects appearance

Question 2

Which kitchen equipment is considered high-risk for cross-contact?

- Sealed containers
- Clean utensils
- Correct Answer: Shared fryers
- Storage shelves

Question 3

Why are shared fryers considered high-risk?

- They cook too quickly
- They increase food cost
- Correct Answer: Allergen proteins can transfer through shared oil
- They affect food temperature

Question 4

What should staff use when preparing allergy orders?

- Dirty utensils
 - Shared cutting boards without cleaning
 - Correct Answer: Clean and sanitized tools and surfaces
 - Guesswork
-

Lesson 2.3 — Handwashing, Gloves, and Safe Handling Procedures

Lesson Purpose

Teach proper handwashing, glove use, and safe food handling procedures.

Lesson Content

Gloves alone do NOT prevent allergen cross-contact.

Hands must be properly washed before changing gloves and before handling allergy-sensitive food.

Proper procedures include:

- Washing hands thoroughly with soap and water
- Changing gloves between tasks
- Washing hands after touching allergen-containing food
- Avoiding contact with multiple surfaces unnecessarily
- Using clean utensils and prep areas

Important:

Wiping gloves or continuing to use the same gloves does NOT make them safe.

Gloves can spread allergens just like hands.

Key Concepts:

- Gloves are not a replacement for handwashing
- Proper handwashing reduces allergen transfer
- Gloves must be changed appropriately
- Safe handling procedures reduce risk

Quiz — Lesson 2.3 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

Do gloves alone prevent allergen cross-contact?

- Yes
- Sometimes
- Correct Answer: No, gloves alone do not prevent cross-contact
- Only during prep

Question 2

When should staff wash their hands?

- Only at the beginning of a shift
- Only after handling raw meat
- Correct Answer: Before changing gloves and after touching allergens
- Only after breaks

Question 3

Can gloves spread allergens?

- No
- Only damaged gloves
- Correct Answer: Yes, gloves can transfer allergens between foods and surfaces
- Only plastic gloves

Question 4

What should staff do after touching allergen-containing food?

- Continue working normally
- Wipe gloves quickly
- Correct Answer: Wash hands and change gloves before handling another dish
- Ignore the risk

Lesson 2.4 — Preventing Cross-Contact During Preparation

Lesson Purpose

Teach safe preparation procedures and organized allergen handling practices.

Lesson Content

Allergy-sensitive meals should be prepared carefully using structured procedures.

Staff should:

- Use clean prep surfaces
- Use clean or separate utensils
- Verify ingredients before use
- Keep allergy orders separate from other foods
- Avoid placing allergy-safe dishes near allergen-containing foods

Whenever possible:

- Use dedicated prep areas
- Use separate equipment
- Minimize unnecessary exposure to allergens

Important:

Never guess whether a dish is safe.

If there is uncertainty:

- Stop the process
- Ask a manager
- Verify ingredients and procedures

Key Concepts:

- Organized preparation reduces risk
- Separation is important
- Ingredient verification is critical
- Uncertainty should always be escalated

Quiz — Lesson 2.4 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

What should staff do before preparing an allergy-sensitive meal?

- Begin cooking immediately
- Ignore nearby foods
- Correct Answer: Use clean prep surfaces and verify ingredients
- Reuse utensils

Question 2

Why should allergy orders be kept separate from other foods?

- To improve appearance
- To speed up cooking
- Correct Answer: To reduce the risk of cross-contact
- To reduce cost

Question 3

What should staff do if they are unsure whether a dish is safe?

- Guess based on experience
- Serve it anyway
- Correct Answer: Stop and verify ingredients or ask a manager
- Ignore the concern

Question 4

What is one benefit of using separate prep areas when possible?

- Faster cooking
- Lower food cost
- Correct Answer: Reduced allergen exposure and cross-contact risk
- Larger menu options

Lesson 2.1 — Understanding Cross-Contact

Quiz: Lesson 2.1 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 2.2 — Cleaning and Kitchen Safety Procedures

Quiz: Lesson 2.2 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 2.3 — Handwashing, Gloves, and Safe Handling Procedures

Quiz: Lesson 2.3 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 2.4 — Preventing Cross-Contact During Preparation

Quiz: Lesson 2.4 Checkpoint Quiz

SECTION 3 — FRONT OF HOUSE COMMUNICATION AND GUEST INTERACTION

Lesson 3.1 — Identifying and Responding to Allergy Disclosures

Lesson Purpose

Teach staff how to properly identify and respond when a guest discloses a food allergy.

Lesson Content

Front of house staff are often the first line of communication when a guest reports a food allergy.

All allergy disclosures must be taken seriously.

Staff should:

- Listen carefully to the guest
- Identify the specific allergen
- Clarify any uncertainty respectfully
- Notify the kitchen clearly
- Escalate to management when needed

Important:

Staff should never dismiss or minimize a guest's allergy.

Examples of appropriate responses:

- "Thank you for letting me know."
- "I'll communicate this with the kitchen immediately."
- "Let me confirm the ingredients and preparation process for you."

Examples to avoid:

- "You'll probably be okay."
- "We've never had a problem before."
- "Just pick it off."

Key Concepts:

- Allergy disclosures require immediate attention

- Clear communication reduces risk
- Guests should be treated respectfully and seriously
- Escalation is appropriate when uncertain

Quiz — Lesson 3.1 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

What should staff do when a guest reports a food allergy?

- Ignore the concern
- Assume it is minor
- Correct Answer: Take the allergy seriously and communicate it clearly
- Continue service without changes

Question 2

Which of the following is an appropriate response to a guest with a food allergy?

- “You’ll probably be fine.”
- “Just remove the ingredient.”
- Correct Answer: “Let me confirm the ingredients and preparation process for you.”
- “We never have issues here.”

Question 3

When should staff escalate an allergy concern?

- Never
- Only during busy shifts
- Correct Answer: When there is uncertainty about ingredients or preparation
- Only if the guest requests it

Question 4

Why is clear communication important when handling allergy disclosures?

- It improves food presentation
 - It reduces menu size
 - Correct Answer: It helps reduce risk and prevent misunderstandings
 - It speeds up cooking
-

Lesson 3.2 — Order Communication and Allergy Workflow

Lesson Purpose

Teach the structured communication process used for allergy orders.

Lesson Content

Allergy orders should follow a clear communication workflow to reduce mistakes and improve consistency.

The AllergenWise Risk Reduction Workflow:

1. Guest informs staff
2. Front of house confirms the allergen
3. Allergy alert is entered clearly into the POS/KDS system
4. Kitchen is notified of the allergy
5. Ingredients and preparation methods are verified
6. Safe handling procedures are followed
7. Manager verification occurs when needed
8. Final confirmation is completed before service
9. Honest communication is maintained with the guest

Important:

Staff should never assume the kitchen saw the allergy note.

During busy shifts, verbal communication may also be necessary.

Examples of effective communication:

- Clearly labeling “SESAME ALLERGY” in the system
- Verbally notifying the kitchen when necessary
- Confirming modifications before serving

Key Concepts:

- Structured workflows reduce mistakes
- Clear allergy alerts are critical
- Communication between FOH and BOH matters
- Verification should happen at every stage

Quiz — Lesson 3.2 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

What is the purpose of the AllergenWise Risk Reduction Workflow?

- Increase menu options
- Speed up service
- Correct Answer: Reduce allergen risk through structured communication and procedures
- Reduce staffing needs

Question 2

Why should allergy alerts be entered clearly into the POS/KDS system?

- To improve presentation
- To reduce food cost
- Correct Answer: To ensure the kitchen recognizes the allergy and follows precautions
- To simplify menus

Question 3

Should staff assume the kitchen saw the allergy note during a busy shift?

- Yes
- Only during slow hours
- Correct Answer: No, verbal confirmation may also be necessary
- Only for severe allergies

Question 4

Which of the following is part of the AllergenWise workflow?

- Ignoring modifications
- Guessing ingredients
- Correct Answer: Verifying ingredients and preparation methods
- Removing communication steps

Lesson 3.3 — Managing Guest Expectations

Lesson Purpose

Teach honest and appropriate communication regarding allergen risk.

Lesson Content

Restaurants should communicate honestly and responsibly with guests regarding food allergies.

No restaurant can guarantee a completely allergen-free environment.

Staff should avoid making guarantees about safety.

Appropriate language includes:

- “We take allergies seriously and will take precautions.”
- “Let me confirm the preparation process for you.”
- “We cannot guarantee a completely allergen-free environment.”

Avoid statements such as:

- “You’ll be fine.”
- “There is no risk.”
- “We guarantee it’s safe.”

If a dish cannot be safely prepared:

- Inform the guest honestly
- Escalate to management
- Offer alternatives when appropriate

Important:

Being honest about limitations helps reduce risk and supports responsible communication.

Key Concepts:

- Restaurants should avoid guarantees
- Honest communication is important
- Safety should come before service speed
- Guests deserve clear information

Quiz — Lesson 3.3 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

Can a restaurant guarantee a completely allergen-free environment?

- Yes
- Only with trained staff
- Correct Answer: No, restaurants cannot guarantee a completely allergen-free environment
- Only during slow hours

Question 2

Which statement is appropriate when speaking with a guest about allergies?

- “There is no risk.”
- “You’ll definitely be safe.”
- Correct Answer: “We take allergies seriously and will take precautions.”
- “You should be fine.”

Question 3

What should staff do if a dish cannot be safely prepared?

- Serve it anyway
- Ignore the concern
- Correct Answer: Inform the guest honestly and escalate when needed
- Guess based on experience

Question 4

Why is honest communication important?

- It speeds up service
- It reduces menu options
- Correct Answer: It helps manage expectations and reduce risk
- It improves food presentation

Lesson 3.4 — Recognizing and Responding to Allergic Reactions

Lesson Purpose

Teach staff how to recognize signs of allergic reactions and respond appropriately.

Lesson Content

Even when proper procedures are followed, allergic reactions may still occur.

Staff should recognize the signs of a possible allergic reaction and respond immediately.

Common symptoms include:

- Hives or rash
- Swelling of the lips, face, or throat
- Difficulty breathing
- Wheezing
- Vomiting
- Dizziness or fainting
- Tightness in the chest

A severe allergic reaction is called anaphylaxis and can become life-threatening quickly.

If a severe reaction is suspected:

1. Alert a manager immediately
2. Call 911
3. Stay with the guest
4. Monitor the guest's condition
5. Assist with an EpiPen if requested

Important:

- Never wait to see if symptoms improve
- Never leave the guest alone
- All reactions should be taken seriously

Key Concepts:

- Allergic reactions can escalate quickly
- Immediate action matters
- Staff should remain calm and responsive
- Emergency awareness is critical

Quiz — Lesson 3.4 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

Which of the following may be a sign of a severe allergic reaction?

- Mild hunger

- Fatigue
- Correct Answer: Difficulty breathing or throat swelling
- Tiredness

Question 2

What should staff do if a severe allergic reaction is suspected?

- Wait to see if symptoms improve
- Ignore the concern
- Correct Answer: Alert a manager and call 911 immediately
- Continue normal service

Question 3

Should allergic reactions always be taken seriously?

- No
- Only if severe
- Correct Answer: Yes, all reactions should be taken seriously
- Only during busy shifts

Question 4

What should staff do after calling for emergency help?

- Leave the guest alone
- Return to work
- Correct Answer: Stay with the guest and monitor their condition
- Ignore the situation

Lesson 3.1 — Identifying and Responding to Allergy Disclosures

Quiz: Lesson 3.1 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 3.2 — Order Communication and Allergy Workflow

Quiz: Lesson 3.2 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 3.3 — Managing Guest Expectations

Quiz: Lesson 3.3 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 3.4 — Recognizing and Responding to Allergic Reactions

Quiz: Lesson 3.4 Checkpoint Quiz

SECTION 4 — BACK OF HOUSE PROCEDURES AND EXECUTION

Lesson 4.1 — Ingredient Verification and Hidden Risks

Lesson Content

Before preparing an allergy-sensitive meal, ingredients must always be verified.

Staff should never assume a dish is safe based on appearance or past experience.

Hidden allergens may exist in:

- Sauces
- Marinades
- Dressings
- Spice blends
- Packaged ingredients
- Fryer coatings
- Prepared foods

Staff should:

- Check ingredient labels when available
- Confirm ingredients with management when uncertain
- Review sauces and pre-made items carefully
- Stop and verify if unsure

Important:

Never guess whether an ingredient contains an allergen.

If ingredients cannot be verified, the safest decision may be to avoid serving the dish.

Quiz — Lesson 4.1 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

Why should ingredients always be verified before preparing an allergy-sensitive meal?

- To improve presentation
- To reduce food cost
- Correct Answer: Hidden allergens may exist in sauces, marinades, and prepared foods
- To speed up service

Question 2

Which of the following may contain hidden allergens?

- Water
- Ice
- Correct Answer: Sauces and spice blends
- Plain napkins

Question 3

What should staff do if they are unsure whether an ingredient contains an allergen?

- Guess based on experience
- Continue preparing the dish
- Correct Answer: Stop and verify the ingredient before serving
- Ignore the concern

Question 4

If ingredients cannot be verified safely, what may be the safest option?

- Serve the dish anyway
- Ignore the concern
- Correct Answer: Avoid serving the dish
- Reduce portion size

Lesson 4.2 — Safe Kitchen Execution Procedures

Lesson Content

Allergy-sensitive meals should follow structured kitchen procedures designed to reduce cross-contact risk.

Before preparation begins:

- Identify the allergy clearly
- Prepare a clean workspace
- Use clean utensils and tools
- Separate allergen-containing foods when possible

During preparation:

- Keep allergy orders separate from other dishes
- Avoid unnecessary exposure to allergens
- Use clean gloves and wash hands appropriately
- Maintain awareness throughout preparation

High-risk situations include:

- Shared fryers
- Shared grills
- Shared prep surfaces
- Shared utensils

Important:

Even small mistakes during preparation can create allergen risk.

Quiz — Lesson 4.2 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

What should staff do before preparing an allergy-sensitive meal?

- Begin cooking immediately
- Reuse dirty utensils
- Correct Answer: Prepare a clean workspace and identify the allergy clearly
- Ignore nearby foods

Question 2

Why should allergy orders be kept separate from other foods?

- To improve presentation
- To increase menu options
- Correct Answer: To reduce the risk of cross-contact
- To reduce cleaning time

Question 3

Which kitchen equipment is considered high-risk for allergen exposure?

- Sealed containers
- Storage shelves
- Correct Answer: Shared fryers and grills
- Ice bins

Question 4

Can small mistakes during preparation create allergen risk?

- No
 - Only during busy shifts
 - Correct Answer: Yes, even small mistakes can create risk
 - Only with shellfish
-

Lesson 4.3 — Final Verification Before Service

Lesson Content

Before an allergy-sensitive dish is served, a final verification step should be completed.

Staff should confirm:

- The correct ingredients were used
- Modifications were completed properly
- No allergen-containing garnish or ingredient was added
- The dish matches the allergy request

Staff should also:

- Visually inspect the plate
- Confirm the correct guest will receive the dish
- Communicate clearly with front of house staff when needed

Important:

The final verification step should never be rushed.

A mistake at the final stage can still expose a guest to allergens.

Quiz — Lesson 4.3 Checkpoint Quiz

Question 1

What is the purpose of final verification before service?

- Improve food presentation
- Speed up service
- Correct Answer: Confirm the dish was prepared safely and correctly
- Reduce food cost

Question 2

What should staff check before serving an allergy-sensitive dish?

- Portion size only
- Table decorations
- Correct Answer: Ingredients, modifications, and possible allergen exposure
- Music volume

Question 3

Should the final verification process be rushed?

- Yes
- Only during busy hours
- Correct Answer: No, final verification should never be rushed
- Only for large tables

Question 4

Why is visual inspection important before serving?

- It improves presentation
- It reduces cleaning time
- Correct Answer: It may help identify incorrect ingredients or garnishes
- It speeds up delivery

SECTION 5 — Systems, Management, and Legal Risk Reduction

Lesson 5.1 — The AllergenWise Risk Reduction Workflow

Quiz: Lesson 5.1 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 5.2 — Manager Decision Making and Escalation

Quiz: Lesson 5.2 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 5.3 — Menu, Labeling, and Allergen Awareness Systems

Quiz: Lesson 5.3 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 5.4 — Legal Protection and Risk Awareness

Quiz: Lesson 5.4 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 5.5 — High-Risk Situations and Special Considerations

Quiz: Lesson 5.5 Checkpoint Quiz

Lesson 5.6 — Daily Allergen Safety Practices

Quiz: Lesson 5.6 Checkpoint Quiz

SECTION 6 — Final Certification Assessment

Final Certification Test

- 25–27 questions
 - 85% passing score
 - Covers all sections and operational workflows
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PROGRAM STRUCTURE

SECTION 1 — Foundations of Food Allergens

Lesson 1.1 — What Is a Food Allergy?

Purpose:

Introduce food allergies, allergic reactions, and the concept of risk reduction.

Key Concepts:

- What a food allergy is
- Immune system reaction
- Difference between allergies and preferences
- Seriousness of allergic reactions
- Risk reduction philosophy
- No guarantee language

Required Addition:

"This training is designed to help restaurants reduce allergen risk through education, communication, and structured procedures.

No restaurant can guarantee a completely allergen-free environment. The goal of this program is to improve awareness, reduce preventable mistakes, and support safer food handling practices."

Quiz Topics:

- Definition of food allergy
 - Seriousness of reactions
 - Risk reduction understanding
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Lesson 1.2 — Understanding the Top 9 Food Allergens**Purpose:**

Teach the FDA Top 9 allergens and common restaurant sources.

Allergens Covered:

1. Milk (Dairy)
2. Eggs
3. Peanuts
4. Tree Nuts
5. Soy

6. Wheat
7. Fish
8. Shellfish
9. Sesame

Required Structure For Each Allergen:

- Definition
- Common uses
- Common restaurant examples
- Hidden sources

Required Common Restaurant Examples:

Milk (Dairy)

Common restaurant examples:

- Cheese
- Butter
- Cream sauces
- Alfredo
- Ranch dressing
- Soups
- Mashed potatoes

Eggs

Common restaurant examples:

- Mayonnaise
- Aioli
- Breading
- Pasta
- Desserts
- Pancake batter

Peanuts

Common restaurant examples:

- Peanut oil
- Sauces

- Desserts
- Asian dishes
- Candy toppings

Tree Nuts

Common restaurant examples:

- Pesto
- Garnishes
- Desserts
- Nut oils
- Salad toppings

Soy

Common restaurant examples:

- Soy sauce
- Marinades
- Dressings
- Teriyaki sauce
- Processed foods

Wheat

Common restaurant examples:

- Bread
- Pasta
- Breading
- Roux
- Soy sauce
- Fried foods

Fish

Common restaurant examples:

- Fish sauce
- Stocks
- Caesar dressing
- Seafood dishes

Shellfish

Common restaurant examples:

- Shrimp
- Crab
- Lobster
- Oyster sauce
- Seafood stock

Sesame

Common restaurant examples:

- Tahini
- Burger buns
- Dressings
- Sesame oil
- Asian sauces

Key Reinforcement:

- Allergens are not always visible
- Ingredients must be verified
- Never guess

Quiz Topics:

- Identifying allergens
- Hidden ingredient awareness
- Common restaurant sources

Lesson 1.3 — Understanding Allergic Reactions and Anaphylaxis

Purpose:

Explain allergic reactions and emergency seriousness.

Key Concepts:

- Mild vs severe reactions

- Anaphylaxis
- Symptoms
- Importance of immediate action

Quiz Topics:

- Symptoms
 - Seriousness
 - Emergency awareness
-

SECTION 2 — Cross-Contact and Safe Handling Procedures

Lesson 2.1 — Understanding Cross-Contact

Purpose:

Teach what cross-contact is and why it creates risk.

Key Concepts:

- Definition of cross-contact
- Difference between contamination and cross-contact
- Allergen proteins transfer easily
- Small amounts can trigger reactions

Critical Reinforcement:

- Cooking does NOT remove allergens
- Wiping surfaces is not enough
- Shared equipment creates risk

Quiz Topics:

- Definition of cross-contact
 - Risk recognition
 - Shared equipment awareness
-

Lesson 2.2 — Cleaning and Kitchen Safety Procedures

Purpose:

Teach proper cleaning and separation procedures.

Key Concepts:

- Cleaning vs wiping
- Sanitizing surfaces
- Separate prep tools
- Separate utensils
- Clean prep areas

Must Reinforce:

- Shared fryers are high-risk
- Shared grills are high-risk
- Pasta water can transfer allergens
- Utensils must be cleaned properly

Quiz Topics:

- Proper cleaning
 - Equipment separation
 - Shared fryer risks
-

Lesson 2.3 — Handwashing, Gloves, and Safe Handling Procedures**Purpose:**

Teach proper handwashing and glove procedures.

Key Concepts:

- Gloves alone are not enough
- Hands must be washed before changing gloves
- Wash after touching allergens
- Avoid touching multiple surfaces
- Replace gloves between tasks

Required Reinforcement:

- Gloves can spread allergens
- Handwashing is critical
- Wiping gloves does NOT make them safe

Quiz Topics:

- Proper glove use
 - Handwashing procedures
 - Safe handling
-

Lesson 2.4 — Preventing Cross-Contact During Preparation

Purpose:

Teach safe preparation procedures.

Key Concepts:

- Separate prep stations
- Ingredient verification
- Dedicated tools when possible
- Organized workflow

Quiz Topics:

- Safe preparation practices
 - Cross-contact prevention
-

SECTION 3 — Front of House Communication and Guest Interaction

Lesson 3.1 — Identifying and Responding to Allergy Disclosures

Purpose:

Teach staff how to identify and respond appropriately when guests disclose allergies.

Key Concepts:

- Taking all allergies seriously
- Listening carefully
- Clarifying allergens
- Escalation procedures

Quiz Topics:

- Allergy disclosure response
 - Escalation awareness
-

Lesson 3.2 — Order Communication and Allergy Workflow**Purpose:**

Teach structured allergy communication workflow.

Official Workflow Name:**The AllergenWise Risk Reduction Workflow****Workflow Steps:**

1. Guest informs staff
2. FOH confirms allergy
3. POS/KDS allergy alert entered
4. Kitchen notified
5. Ingredients verified
6. Safe prep procedures followed
7. Manager verification when needed
8. Final confirmation before service
9. Honest communication with guest

Key Concepts:

- Clear communication
- Allergy flags
- Consistency
- Escalation

Quiz Topics:

- Workflow understanding
 - Communication procedures
-

Lesson 3.3 — Managing Guest Expectations

Purpose:

Teach honest and appropriate communication.

Required Language Concepts:

Appropriate language:

- "We take allergies seriously and will take precautions."
- "I need to confirm with the kitchen."
- "We cannot guarantee a completely allergen-free environment."

Avoid:

- "You'll be fine"
- "It's completely safe"
- "There is no risk"

Key Concepts:

- Honest communication
- No guarantees
- Risk transparency
- Escalation when uncertain

Quiz Topics:

- Appropriate language
 - Unsafe statements
-

Lesson 3.4 — Recognizing and Responding to Allergic Reactions

Purpose:

Teach emergency recognition and response procedures.

Symptoms Covered:

- Hives
- Swelling
- Difficulty breathing
- Wheezing
- Vomiting
- Dizziness
- Throat tightness

Emergency Response Steps:

1. Take situation seriously
2. Alert manager immediately
3. Call 911
4. Stay with guest
5. Assist with EpiPen if requested

Key Reinforcement:

- Never wait to see if symptoms improve
- Never leave guest alone
- Immediate response can save a life

Quiz Topics:

- Reaction symptoms
 - Emergency response
 - Anaphylaxis awareness
-

SECTION 4 — Back of House Procedures and Execution

Lesson 4.1 — Ingredient Verification and Hidden Risks

Purpose:

Teach ingredient verification procedures.

Key Concepts:

- Verify ingredients
- Never assume
- Review sauces and marinades
- Check packaged ingredients

Quiz Topics:

- Ingredient verification
 - Hidden allergens
-

Lesson 4.2 — Safe Kitchen Execution Procedures**Purpose:**

Teach kitchen execution protocols.

Key Concepts:

- Separate prep
- Clean tools
- Allergy identification
- Controlled workflow

Quiz Topics:

- Kitchen execution
 - Safe preparation
-

Lesson 4.3 — Final Verification Before Service**Purpose:**

Teach final verification procedures.

Key Concepts:

- Final review before serving

- Confirm modifications
- Verify allergy order
- Prevent serving mistakes

Quiz Topics:

- Final verification
 - Safe service procedures
-

SECTION 5 — Systems, Management, and Legal Risk Reduction

Lesson 5.1 — The AllergenWise Risk Reduction Workflow

Purpose:

Reinforce complete operational workflow.

Workflow Reinforcement:

- FOH communication
- POS/KDS entry
- Kitchen execution
- Verification
- Honest communication

Quiz Topics:

- Workflow sequencing
 - Operational understanding
-

Lesson 5.2 — Manager Decision Making and Escalation

Purpose:

Define manager responsibilities.

Key Concepts:

- Escalation
- Risk assessment
- Decision making
- Declining service when necessary

Required Reinforcement:

Safety over speed.

Quiz Topics:

- Escalation
 - Decision making
 - Declining service
-

Lesson 5.3 — Menu, Labeling, and Allergen Awareness Systems

Purpose:

Teach system consistency and operational structure.

Key Concepts:

- Menu labeling
- POS/KDS indicators
- Standardized language
- Consistency across staff

Quiz Topics:

- Labeling systems
 - Operational consistency
-

Lesson 5.4 — Legal Protection and Risk Awareness

Purpose:

Teach legal and communication principles.

Key Concepts:

- No guarantees
- Reasonable risk reduction
- Honest communication
- Documentation

Required Language:

"We take allergies seriously and will take precautions, but cannot guarantee a completely allergen-free environment."

Quiz Topics:

- Appropriate communication
 - Risk reduction philosophy
-

Lesson 5.5 — High-Risk Situations and Special Considerations**Purpose:**

Teach high-risk operational scenarios.

High-Risk Areas Covered:

- Shared fryers
- Shared grills
- Pasta water
- Shared prep surfaces
- Unclear ingredients

Guest Risk Acceptance:

A guest accepting risk does NOT remove the restaurant's responsibility to follow allergen procedures.

Key Concepts:

- Never guess
- Decline service when necessary
- Risk cannot always be controlled

Quiz Topics:

- High-risk equipment
 - Ingredient uncertainty
 - Declining service
-

Lesson 5.6 — Daily Allergen Safety Practices**Purpose:**

Create daily operational reinforcement.

Daily Practices:

- Verify ingredients daily
- Communicate menu changes
- Maintain clean prep areas
- Reinforce allergy awareness during rushes
- Escalate uncertainty immediately
- Review high-risk items regularly

Key Concepts:

- Consistency
- Daily awareness
- Operational discipline

Quiz Topics:

- Daily procedures
 - Operational reinforcement
-

SECTION 6 — Final Certification Assessment**Assessment Requirements**

- 25–27 questions
- Mix of operational and scenario-based questions

- Covers all sections
- Passing score: 85%

Final Assessment Topics:

- Food allergies
- Top 9 allergens
- Cross-contact
- Cleaning
- Handwashing
- FOH communication
- BOH procedures
- Emergency response
- High-risk situations
- Manager escalation
- Legal communication
- Risk reduction workflow

Final Assessment Settings

- Shuffle questions: ON
- Shuffle answers: ON
- Allow retakes if failed
- Recommended attempts: 3
- Show correct answers only when passed
- Show correct/incorrect labels ON
- Show score ON

CERTIFICATION STRUCTURE**Individual Certification****Name:**

AllergenWise Certification

Purpose:

Confirms employee completed allergen risk reduction training.

Certificate Validity:

2 years

RESTAURANT PARTICIPATION SYSTEM**Recommended Restaurant Recognition Language****DO NOT USE:**

- Allergen-Free Certified
- Guaranteed Safe

USE:

- AllergenWise Trained Team
 - AllergenWise Participating Location
 - AllergenWise Risk Reduction Partner
-

OPTIONAL RESTAURANT BADGES / ICON SYSTEM

Restaurants may optionally identify operational practices such as:

- Peanut Aware
- Sesame Restricted
- Dedicated Fryer
- Dedicated Prep Area
- Staff Allergen Trained

Important:

These badges should reflect operational practices and NOT guarantee allergen-free food.

DEVELOPER IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

Required Platform Features

User Features:

- User accounts
- Course progress tracking
- Quiz tracking
- Final assessment
- Certificate generation
- Certificate expiration tracking

Restaurant Features:

- Organization-level accounts
- Employee completion tracking
- Restaurant participation badge management
- Optional icon selection

Workflow Features:

- Structured section progression
- Quiz completion requirements
- Final assessment gating

Certification Logic:

Certificate only generated when:

- All sections completed
- Final assessment passed

DESIGN / UI GUIDELINES

Overall Style

- Clean
- Professional
- Hospitality-focused
- Modern compliance aesthetic

Avoid:

- Hospital aesthetic
 - Overly academic styling
 - Cartoon visuals
 - Excessive warning language
-

BRAND POSITIONING SUMMARY

AllergenWise is NOT:

- a guarantee system
- a medical certification
- an allergen-free certification

AllergenWise IS:

- a restaurant allergen risk-reduction system
 - an operational awareness framework
 - a communication and handling training program
 - a structured workflow and education platform
-

FINAL STRATEGIC NOTE

The strongest differentiator of AllergenWise is not simply allergen education.

The strongest differentiator is:

- operational workflow structure
- communication systems
- realistic restaurant implementation
- risk reduction positioning
- honest and defensible safety language

This positioning should remain consistent across:

- the platform
- restaurant onboarding

- marketing materials
- certification language
- sales presentations
- public-facing seals and badges